

1 Urban Flood Governance

GS III

Governance

Core Issue

Critical infrastructure cybersecurity must protect not only core systems, but also **contractors, vendors**, cloud services and connected supply chains.

What's Happening?

A ransomware group reportedly leaked files linked to a contractor working on the Kudankulam nuclear power project, although the operational reactor network was stated to be unaffected.

Why It Matters

Cyber incidents involving nuclear infrastructure can affect **national security**, public confidence, institutional credibility and the safety of strategic assets.

Key Challenges

Delayed breach disclosure, weak incident response, poor vendor security, limited coordination and treating cybersecurity mainly as a compliance exercise reduce preparedness.

The Way Forward

India needs stronger supply-chain security standards, timely disclosure, regular audits, better cyber hygiene and coordinated action by CERT-In, operators and private partners.

RECALL QUESTIONS

- 1 Why do Indian cities continue to face severe urban flooding?
- 2 What governance reforms can improve urban flood resilience?

QUICK FACTS

- CERT-In is India's national cyber incident response agency.
- Kudankulam is India's largest nuclear power project.
- Ransomware attacks may involve both encryption and data theft.
- Supply-chain attacks often target contractors instead of core systems.
- Critical infrastructure follows layered cyber-security architecture.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Cybersecurity for critical infrastructure must extend beyond reactors to **vendors, contractors** and digital supply chains through proactive protection and transparent incident response.

2 Strengthening Parliamentary Committee Scrutiny for Better Governance

GS II

Polity

Core Issue

Parliamentary committees improve legislative scrutiny by examining bills, budgets, ministries and public policies in greater detail than is possible during full House debates.

What's Happening?

Concerns continue over weak committee referrals, limited discussion time and reduced institutional scrutiny of important legislation.

Why It Matters

Strong committee oversight improves **accountability**, evidence-based lawmaking, executive control and the quality of parliamentary democracy.

Key Challenges

Non-binding recommendations, limited research support, inconsistent referrals and political majorities can weaken committee effectiveness.

The Way Forward

Important bills should receive regular committee scrutiny, research support must improve, and governments should provide reasoned responses to committee recommendations.

RECALL QUESTIONS

- 1 Why are parliamentary committees important for legislative scrutiny?
- 2 What limits the effectiveness of committee oversight in India?

QUICK FACTS

- Department-related Standing Committees examine Bills in detail.
- Committee recommendations are advisory in nature.
- Parliamentary Committees improve legislative scrutiny.
- Committee reports strengthen executive accountability.
- Both Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha have Standing Committees.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Strong Parliamentary Committees improve **accountability**, legislative quality and executive oversight, making them essential to a healthy parliamentary democracy.